

Gautam Velpula

Vice President of Technology

AI-Native Platforms & Agentic AI • Hands-On Architecture & Full-Stack • Data Platform & BI •
Build vs. Buy & Lean Team Building

Atlanta, GA | gautamvelpula@gmail.com | linkedin.com/in/gautamvelpula | 678-539-0154

Executive Summary

Hands-on technology executive with 18+ years spanning strategy, architecture, and building — partnering directly with CEOs and executive teams while remaining deep in the technical details. Proven track record architecting AI-native, cloud platforms from the ground up, making pragmatic build-vs-buy decisions, and standing up data and BI capabilities that turn operational data into decisions. A true player-coach who prototypes, reviews architecture, and writes code to unblock the team, then recruits and develops the lean, high-performing organization to scale it. Combines a builder's mindset, executive-level product and business instincts, and experience owning security and compliance in regulated environments.

Core Competencies

CEO & Executive-Team Partnership • Technology & Product Vision • AI-Native Platforms, Agentic AI & Automation • Hands-On Architecture & Full-Stack (JavaScript / TypeScript, Node.js) • Data Platform, Warehousing & BI • Build vs. Buy • Cloud & Microservices • Mobile & Patient / Customer Engagement • Security & Compliance in Regulated Environments (PCI DSS; HIPAA / SOC 2-ready) • Player-Coach Leadership • Lean Team Building • Cross-Functional Delivery (Clinical / Ops / Business)

Professional Experience

GoTo Foods LLC

2021 – Present

Sr Director, Enterprise Architecture

- Partner directly with executive leadership to define technology and product strategy for a multi-brand, multi-site consumer organization, owning the decisions of what to build, what to buy, and how to architect a scalable, differentiated platform.
- Architected and delivered a modern, cloud-native platform from a fragmented legacy estate — consolidating 7 independent brand apps and websites into a unified, connected experience across web and mobile while materially reducing cost and improving reliability.
- Lead the **GoTo Foods AI Working Group**, the enterprise governing body reviewing and approving all AI initiatives, and architect **AI-native, agentic AI workflows and automation** that streamline back-office operations and improve decision-making and efficiency.
- Drive adoption of **modern AI tooling and AI-assisted development**, including rollout of Claude and GitHub Copilot, and leverage AWS Bedrock with frontier models from Anthropic, OpenAI, and Google to build intelligent systems.
- Built and own the enterprise data foundation — a centralized customer data model with CDP, Databricks, and analytics integrations — turning operational, marketing, and behavioral data into decisions across the business.
- Direct **build-vs-buy and vendor/SaaS decisions**, focusing investment where it creates real differentiation and ensuring architectural consistency across third-party platforms.
- Re-architected backend systems to cloud-native microservices and event-driven services with standardized APIs, SQL and NoSQL data stores, monitoring, and alerting, improving system uptime by approximately 30%.

- Delivered mobile applications (React Native) and modern checkout/engagement experiences, partnering with product and business teams on user experience and workflow design.
- Own security and compliance in a regulated, high-volume payments environment as a continuous participant in the annual **PCI DSS** audit, partnering with security leadership on secure-by-design standards and risk management.
- Operate as a hands-on **player-coach** — prototyping, reviewing architecture, and writing code to unblock the team, including hands-on development of a stop-gap service that stabilized revenue during legacy system failures.
- Recruited and developed a lean, high-performing organization of senior and principal engineers, setting a high bar for speed, quality, ownership, and pragmatism.

Slalom Consulting

2018 – 2021

Senior Delivery Principal

- Senior engineering and advisory lead for multi-million-dollar digital, cloud modernization, and payments engagements with growth-stage and Fortune 500 clients.
- Advised executives on build-vs-buy, target architecture, and modernization roadmaps, translating business strategy into pragmatic, executable technology plans and TCO models.
- Led a major cloud migration from on-premises and AWS to **GCP** for a leading point-of-sale provider, modernizing infrastructure, data, and application tiers.
- Conducted a multi-year architecture assessment of a legacy payments platform for one of the largest U.S. eCommerce companies, defining the target-state architecture and reusable platform capabilities.
- Designed and delivered payment processing systems for a large financial services organization, addressing security, resilience, and high-volume, low-latency requirements.
- Implemented Agile and DevOps operating models, increasing deployment frequency by approximately 30% and reducing lead time by approximately 25%.
- Stayed hands-on across engagements, going deep on architecture and implementation to unblock teams and de-risk delivery.

Jacada (acquired by Uniphore)

2014 – 2018

Director, Professional Services

- Built and scaled a lean, global services and engineering organization from the ground up through recruiting, training, and standardized delivery practices.
- Owned end-to-end delivery for enterprise customers, leading solution architecture, implementation, and post-launch optimization for Fortune 500 clients.
- Advised C-level stakeholders, aligning delivery with business outcomes and managing executive relationships.
- Served as senior-most technical leader within services, remaining hands-on to solve critical technical challenges directly.

Technology & Methodology

Languages & Full-Stack: JavaScript / TypeScript, Node.js, Java (Spring Boot), NestJS, Next.js, React Native, SQL & NoSQL

AI & Tooling: GenAI, Agentic AI, AI-driven automation, AWS Bedrock, Claude (Anthropic), GitHub Copilot; frontier models from Anthropic, OpenAI, and Google; AI governance & guardrails

Data & BI: Centralized data models, data warehousing & BI, Databricks, Cosmos DB (MongoDB & PostgreSQL APIs), Event Hub, Service Bus, GA4

Cloud & Platform: AWS, Google Cloud Platform (GCP), Microsoft Azure (AKS, API Management, Functions, Front Door, Blob Storage), Vercel, Cloudflare

Architecture: Microservices, Event-Driven Architecture, REST / GraphQL APIs, API Gateways, Systems Integration

Reliability & Security: Monitoring & alerting (Splunk), incident management, PCI DSS (annual audit participant), DevSecOps, Secure-by-Design

Methodologies: Agile / Scrum, DevOps & Continuous Delivery, Build vs. Buy, Lean / Growth-Stage Execution

Education

Master of Science in Information Technology

2007 – 2009

George Mason University, Fairfax, VA

Bachelor of Technology in Computer Science

2002 – 2006

Osmania University, Hyderabad, India